on his promise, but it provided a means to de-escalate the situation once again.[16]

Despite the danger Pakistan's proxies posed to regionally stability, the US continued to view tackling the Kashmir jihad as too difficult in the near term. Instead it remained committed to an incremental approach designed to pressure Pakistan to reduce support for militancy over time. Yet a month after making his pledge to Armitage, President Musharraf made clear during an interview with *Newsweek* that his commitment came with an expiration date:

> I've told President Bush nothing is happening across the Line of Control. This is the assurance I've given. I'm not going to give you an assurance that for years nothing will happen. We have to have a response from India, a discussion about Kashmir. If you want a guarantee of peace in this region, there are three ways: (1) denuclearize South Asia; (2) ensure a conventional deterrence so that war never takes place in the Subcontinent; (3) find a solution to the Kashmir problem.[17]

In 2003 the government of Pakistan decided to keep alive its strategic assets for use against India and the 'good jihadis' were told they would not be dismantled provided they calibrate their activity in Indian-administered Kashmir per the direction of the state, remove fighting America from their agendas and abstain from attacks within Pakistan.[18] Ambassador to Pakistan Nancy Powell complained publicly in November that jihadi groups were reconstituting themselves under new names. Singling out Lashkar and JeM, Powell said 'These groups pose a serious threat to Pakistan, to the region and to the United States.' Lashkar was widely understood to be operating openly under the JuD banner, while Jaish had reemerged as Khuddam-ul-Islam. In response to US pressure, President Musharraf banned Khuddam-ul-Islam [formerly JeM] along with two sectarian groups, which had reemerged under new names: Millat-e-Islamiyah Pakistan [formerly SSP] and Islami Tehrik Pakistan [formerly Tehrik-e-Jafria, a Shia Party].[19] Several days later Musharraf also banned Jamaat-ul-Furqan [a JeM splinter group], Jamiat-ul-Ansar [formerly HuM] and Hizb-ul-Tahrir, which was previously legal.[20] JuD escaped this second round of bans and was only placed on a government watch list, leaving Lashkar with a legitimate front organization in Pakistan. One member of Pakistan's Anti-Terrorism Force told the author that this owed to its leadership's commitment to adhere to the state's guidelines in exchange for